HANDEDNESS

Early childhood may be regarded as a critical period in the establishment of handedness. During this period, children shift from the use of one hand to the other and are asked to concentrate on learning skills with one dominant hand and other as the auxiliary or helping hand. For example in case of colouring, the dominant hand is used for colouring and the auxiliary to hold the paper.



Handedness



- **Rivalry-** Children feel an urge to out-do others at home and outside.
- **Co-operation-** Children at the end of the third year learn to socialize and co-operate with their peer group. Their inclination to play with other children increases.
- **Sympathy-** Play contacts develop sympathetic attitudes in children. This helps in understanding feelings and emotions of others.
- **Sharing-** Sharing and caring will win social approval. Children learn this while playing with friends.

ii. Unsocial Behaviors

- **Negativism-** The habit of contradicting elders starts between 3 and 4 years and then it declines.
- **Aggressiveness-** The physically aggressive behaviour that begins by the age of 2, normally declines by the age of 4 giving way to verbal attacks like name calling or blaming others.
- **Bossiness-** Children become more authoritative at the age of 3.
- **Destruction-** The children display their temper by destroying anything within their reach.

d. Emotional Development

The emotional expressions of children differ from those of adults. Emotions can be broadly classified as positive emotions (integrative) and negative emotions (disintegrative). Such emotions are joy, affection, curiosity and sympathy. Negative emotions on the other hand give an unpleasant feeling and disliked by others. The examples of such negative emotions are anger, fear, jealousy, envy, grief and anxiety.

e. Cognitive Development

The mental development that occurs in early childhood is exciting and dynamic as children explore their environment, develop ideas, learn solutions to problems, participate in imaginary play, and gain a unique understanding of the world and how it operates. Children make judgments based on a limited understanding of operations and rules and with minimal cues and information. Young children may have trouble telling

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